



IIT ROORKEE



NPTEL ONLINE
CERTIFICATION COURSE

Public Speaking

Lecture 35: Speeches for Special Occasions

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Need for Speech Presentation

- ❑ According to Merriam-Webster, speech is “the communication or expression of thoughts in spoken words.”
- ❑ Its basic components are **articulation**, **voice**, and **agency**.
- ❑ There are different types of speeches for different occasions.



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Speeches for Special Occasions

- ❑ These types of speeches are delivered to mark the significance of any special occasion.
- ❑ However, there are certain constraints when it comes to the specific occasion.
- ❑ These constraints are not absolute.



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Speeches for Special Occasions



Speeches of Introduction

Speeches of Presentation and Acceptance

Keynote Speeches

Felicitation/Eulogy Speeches

Commemorative Speeches

Farewell Speeches

Vote of Thanks

❑ Speeches of Introduction

- These comprise a brief introduction of the guest speaker by the host of any ceremony.
- However, it should also have an introduction, body and conclusion.
- The intended speaker should be invited in the concluding remarks where their achievements should be highlighted.



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Speeches of Introduction: Purposes

- ✓ To create enthusiasm for the speaker
- ✓ To familiarize the audience with speaker's topic
- ✓ To create an amicable climate
- ✓ To help the speaker's credibility

Caution during Speeches of Introduction

- ❖ Be brief and accurate.
- ❖ Pronounce the speaker's name correctly.
- ❖ Avoid heaping too much praise and embarrassing details.
- ❖ Adapt your remarks to the audience.
- ❖ Make your introduction creative and dramatic.

Contd...

- ❖ Friends, we have a very special guest amidst us today. It is my proud privilege to introduce to you today a cricketer, captain, commentator and coach. In addition to knowing the gimmicks and tricks of the game, today's guest is also credited with writing a very famous book which many of you might have come across. A sportsperson who has brought international acclaims to the country, he is an all-time inspiration to the lovers of cricket. Many of you might have heard about the hitting of six sixes in six continuous balls of an over. I'm quite hopeful that most of you'll find your time worth hearing Mr. X. Let me not stand between you and the speaker and present to you our esteemed guest, Mr. X.
- ❖ Greetings of the day! It is my pleasure to introduce you all to Mr. Tyler King who is a well-established accountant and gym trainer. He is extremely passionate person with over six medals in weight lifting championships and recipient of the award of the best employee in his bank. Mr. King is the certified personal trainer you will work with to achieve your goals.

Speeches of Presentation

- Adapt to the audience.
- Acknowledge the achievements of the recipients.
- Tell the audience about the award.
- Never forget to praise the losers too.

❑ Speeches of Acceptance

- ❖ This is delivered by the recipient of any award or honour.
- ❖ It usually begins by thanking the honouring presenter and institution.
- ❖ It includes words of gratitude for all the help received by the recipient.
- ❖ It should be short. Practice brevity, humility and graciousness.



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I want to thank the jury members, the complete cast and the crew for their endless support. I want to thank my parents and my partner for supporting me and encouraging me in my mission. This award is a dream come true for me . All I can say is that I always wanted to live the role that I was given and never knew I could come true to the expectations of my admirers. I am extremely grateful once again to the selectors and offer my heartfelt thanks to everyone.

❑ Keynote Speeches

- ❑ A speech presented near the beginning of a meeting to guide its thematic agenda and to help set its tone (Lucas 360).
- ❑ It defines the diversity of the audience.
- ❑ It sets the thematic agenda of a meeting or occasion.



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☐ Commemorative Speeches/Eulogy

- Speeches of praise/ celebration
- Not meant to inform but also to inspire
- Anticipation and good wishes, lament, admiration and respect
- A special form of the testimonial speech, honouring someone who has died.
- Most often delivered at funerals and memory services.
- A positive tone and focuses on the virtues of the dead.



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Example: My aunt was a vibrant and kind soul who lit up the room whenever she entered. Aunt Helen was full of joy and always eager to help out during every hard time. She was in pain but never stopped smiling till the end. She is an inspiration and will remain close to my heart forever and always.



A Sample Commemorative Speech

Today we have gathered here to express our heartfelt grief and sorrow in the sudden demise of our most revered politician and statesman, Mr. X. The cruel hands of death have snatched away from us Mr. X . A voice that was always sought after not only in political rallies but also in the heated sessions of the parliament will simply remain a memory today onwards.

We shall hear no more the poetic numbers suffused with political overtones that could make even his opponents admire him. An eloquent speaker, Mr. X mixed subtle humour even in his acerbic remarks without annoying anyone. Never to compromise with his principles of patriotism, Mr. X stood firm in diplomatic relations with neighbouring countries. An excellent human being full of organizational skills, he knew how to build party from brick to brick despite the odds. He believed in democracy where numbers mattered for power but would not hesitate to resign from his coveted post when his party lost majority in the parliament. In his passing away, the country seems to have lost an era of the politics of principles and principles of politics. We will overcome this tough time but the void left by him will never be bridged.





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❑ Speech of Farewell

- This is delivered at the time of parting with someone or switching jobs or any similar occasion.
- One should be thankful for all the support and lessons learnt in either a good or hard manner.
- It should always be ended on a high note.
- One should avoid negative pieces of information.

❑ Vote of Thanks

- It is a well-prepared speech curated and delivered at the official close of any ceremony.
- All the involved entities in the ceremony are formally thanked for their enthusiasm and constant support for the accomplishment of the event.
- Participants and volunteers should not be missed out.

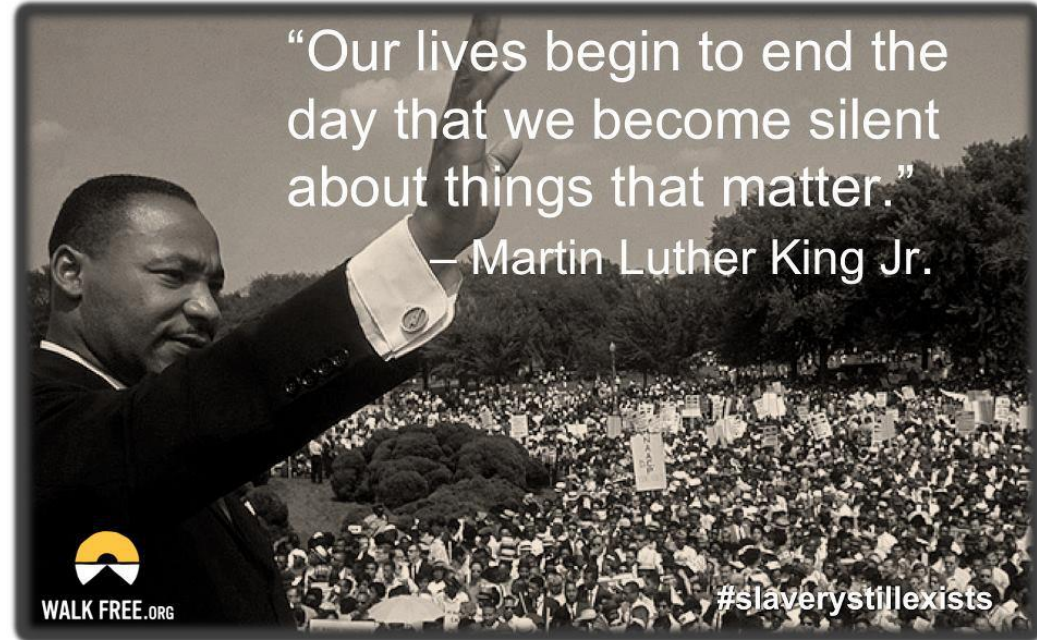


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Good evening everyone. I am here to extend a formal vote of thanks. I would like to thank the guest of honour for her wonderful speech. I extend my gratitude to my fellow colleagues, and our staff. I would also like to thank the audience for their patience and support. This conference would never have been a success without the participation of presenters from different parts of India even amid cold waves . I thank them all. Thanks are also due to all our supporting staff members, student volunteers and research scholars of our department. I also put on record the help and assistance received from different agencies for their unstinted support. Such a grand conference couldn't have been possible without everyday coverage in various newspapers and hence I feel beholden to all the media personnel for their support. Finally, I thank everyone who directly or indirectly helped this conference meet its expectations. Thank you everyone.

❑ Speeches for Motivating

- It targets the emotive side of the audience.
- It triggers fear, joy, sadness, and excitement in the audience.
- It usually falls in the domain of heroism or some exceptional experiences.
- One can be motivated by someone who has hands-on experience in overcoming an adverse condition.



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Motivational Speech Examples

- **TED talks**
 - These have been extremely popular and have an altogether different fanbase.
 - TED Talks are influential videos from expert speakers in diverse fields like education, consumerism, disease, technology, business, science, creativity, etc. with subtitles in multiple languages.



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- YouTube Videos
 - YouTube videos have been extremely popular among all masses because of the availability of every possible content. With the advent of the Internet, people have benefitted from YouTube and other similar sites offering a gateway to the world.



Speeches at Parties

- ☐ These speeches neither inform nor persuade.
- ☐ Their prime function is to entertain the intended audience.
- ☐ One has to be a **crowd-pleaser**.
- ☐ The overall themes should include
 - Optimism
 - Strictly uncomplicated
 - Lively



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☐ Toasts

- A toast is a brief speech to acknowledge any achievement, appreciation, or remembrance.
- It often includes a memory, an anecdote and is mostly short.



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☐ After-Dinner Speeches

- It follows a banquet or meal.
- It is extremely simple.
- It is a speech of celebration.

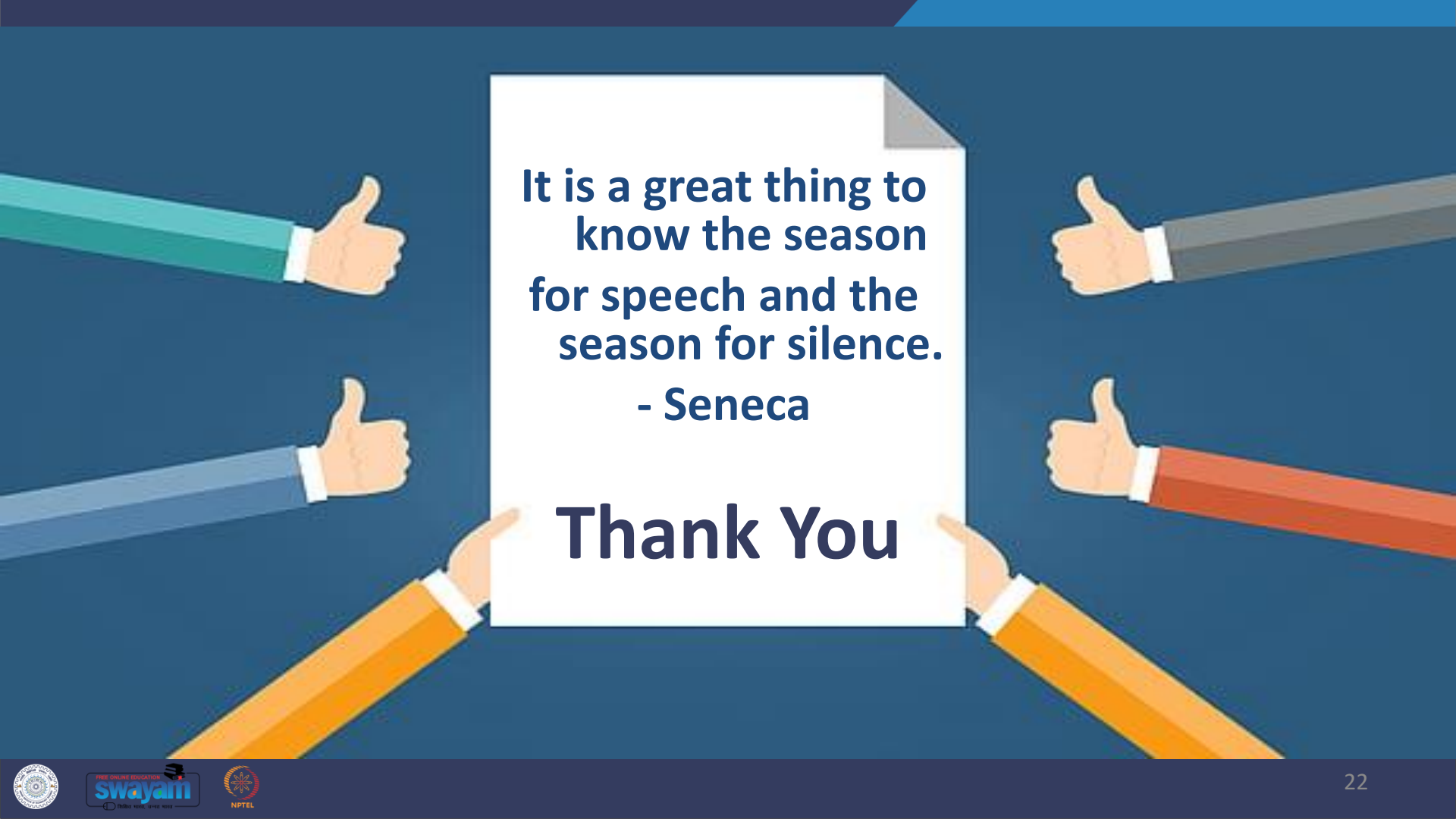


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□ Summarizing event or meeting

- It is essential as it tabulates the main idea of any event.
- Every key point should be included as it becomes a major takeaway for the audience.
- Brushing the key points is essential and a must in the end.



**It is a great thing to
know the season
for speech and the
season for silence.**

- Seneca

Thank You

Work Consulted

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